

ships past the batteries at Port Hudson while the Union Army mounted a diversionary land attack. But coordination failed and Farragut carried out his river operation without support. The Confederate guns disabled five of Farragut's ships; only USS *Hartford* and a gunboat made it past the batteries. The losses were a serious setback, but the surviving force was still sufficient for Farragut to help the Army in the subsequent siege of Port Hudson, by preventing Confederate supplies coming down the Red River.



Sword of honor

This jeweled sword was presented to Farragut by admiring New Yorkers on April 23, 1864. The blade is inscribed: "... as a token of their appreciation of his gallant services rendered in defense of his country."

"You fellows will **catch the devil**
before you get **through with**
this business."

FARRAGUT ADDRESSING CONFEDERATES

Inspiring courage

After a period of well-earned rest in New York, Farragut was given the task in 1864 of attacking Mobile, Alabama. Lack of troops for a land-sea operation to take the city of Mobile meant that Farragut settled for the capture of Mobile Bay and the ships there. This was in itself an ambitious goal, for Confederate defenses were well prepared. Farragut's squadron would have to pass under the guns of Fort Morgan along a channel sown with mines (then called torpedoes) and fight Confederate ships that included the large ironclad CSS *Tennessee*.